

IT Helpdesk Knowledge Base

Synthetic Internal Support Guide • Edition 02 • Access, VPN, Passwords & Hardware

Organization: Northstar Analytics Group **Document Owner:** Corporate IT

Purpose: Standardize support for common employee IT issues and provide clear escalation paths.

Security Notice: IT support will never ask for your password, MFA approval, recovery code, or private authentication token.

1. Getting IT Support

Northstar Analytics Group uses a centralized Helpdesk for account, endpoint, software, network, and equipment requests.

Support Area	Team	Examples
Identity & Access	Access Services	Passwords, MFA, account lockouts
Network	Network Operations	VPN, Wi-Fi, internal connectivity
Endpoint	Device Services	Laptop, monitor, peripherals
Applications	Business Applications	Approved software and application errors
Security	Security Operations	Phishing, suspicious activity, lost devices

Support Contacts

- Helpdesk Portal: <https://example.com/northstar/it>
- Support Email: it-support@example.com
- Knowledge Center: <https://example.com/northstar/kb>
- Critical IT Channel: [#it-urgent](#)

The addresses above are fictional placeholders for this synthetic document.

2. Ticket Priority

Priority	Definition	Example	Initial Response
P1 Critical	Organization-wide or major security impact	Identity platform unavailable	15 minutes
P2 High	Critical business function affected	Employee cannot access production system	60 minutes
P3 Normal	Standard employee issue	VPN connection problem	4 business hours
P4 Low	Routine request	Keyboard replacement	1 business day

3. VPN Knowledge Base

What is the Corporate VPN?

The corporate VPN creates an authenticated connection to approved internal services when an employee is outside the trusted corporate network.

How to Connect

- Connect to a reliable internet network.
- Open the approved Northstar VPN client.
- Select the Northstar corporate profile.
- Sign in with your company account.
- Complete the required MFA verification.
- Confirm that the client displays Connected.
- Open the internal application you need.

VPN Troubleshooting Matrix

Problem	Possible Cause	Resolution
Login rejected	Credential issue or account lock	Verify account status; use password recovery if needed.
MFA timeout	Network or device time issue	Check internet and device time; retry once.
Connects then drops	Unstable network	Move to a stable connection and reconnect.
Connected, but internal site fails	Routing/DNS issue	Reconnect and test another internal service.
VPN client crashes	Client installation issue	Restart device; contact Endpoint Support if repeated.

VPN Escalation

- Escalate immediately if several employees report the same outage.
- Include the VPN client version, device type, time of failure, and exact error message.
- Do not repeatedly enter credentials if the account may be locked.

4. Password Reset & Account Recovery

Employees should use the self-service identity portal whenever possible.

Self-Service Reset

- Open the company identity portal.
- Choose Forgot Password / Reset Password.
- Complete identity verification.
- Create a new unique password.
- Sign in again and complete MFA.
- Reconnect to VPN if required.

Password Rules

- Use a long, unique password or approved passphrase.
- Never reuse corporate credentials on personal websites.
- Never send passwords through email or chat.
- Store credentials only in the approved password manager.
- Do not write passwords on paper near your workstation.

Locked Account

If the account becomes locked, stop attempting random passwords. Use the recovery workflow or contact the Helpdesk. Support staff must verify identity before restoring access.

5. MFA Troubleshooting

Issue	What to Try	Escalation
No approval prompt	Check network and notification settings	Access Services
Wrong code	Verify device time is synchronized	Access Services
New phone	Complete approved device enrollment	Access Services
Lost MFA device	Report immediately	Access + Security
Unexpected MFA prompt	Reject it and report it	Security Operations

6. Hardware Request Center

Hardware is issued based on role requirements, inventory, compatibility, security standards, and manager approval.

Request	Typical Use	Information Needed	Approval
Laptop	New hire or replacement	Role, location, required software	Manager
Monitor	Second/ergonomic display	Desk setup, size preference	Manager if non-standard
Dock	Multi-monitor workstation	Laptop model, displays	Usually automatic
Headset	Calls and meetings	Role and usage	Usually automatic
Keyboard/Mouse	Replacement or ergonomic setup	Model preference, reason	Usually automatic
Mobile Device	Approved business use	Business justification	Manager + IT

Hardware Request Workflow

- Create a ticket in the IT portal.
- Choose the hardware category.
- Provide a business reason.
- Enter your location and shipping details.
- Attach manager approval when required.
- IT checks inventory and compatibility.
- IT assigns or orders the equipment.
- Confirm receipt and asset information.

7. Device Replacement

A device may be replaced when it is damaged, unreliable, incompatible with required software, or beyond its supported lifecycle.

- Describe recurring symptoms rather than simply requesting a replacement.
- Include asset tag and device model.
- Provide the approximate age of the device.
- Back up company data using approved storage before returning equipment.
- Do not dispose of company hardware yourself.

8. Lost or Stolen Equipment

Lost or stolen company equipment should be reported immediately because it may represent a security risk.

- Contact IT Helpdesk immediately.
- Contact Security Operations when sensitive data may be exposed.
- Provide the asset tag or serial number if available.
- State the approximate time and location.
- Follow instructions for account-session protection.
- Do not attempt to recover stolen equipment yourself.

Do not delay reporting because you are still searching for the device.

9. Workstation Troubleshooting

Computer Is Slow

- Save your work and restart the computer.
- Close unused applications and browser tabs.

- Check available storage space.
- Install pending approved updates.
- Contact IT if the problem continues after restart.

Wi-Fi Problems

- Confirm Wi-Fi is enabled.
- Check whether other websites work.
- Reconnect to the approved network.
- Restart the network adapter or device if appropriate.
- Report the issue if multiple nearby employees are affected.

Application Error

- Record the exact error message.
- Note when the issue started.
- Restart the application.
- Restart the computer if appropriate.
- Check the internal status page if available.
- Submit a ticket with screenshots that do not contain sensitive data.

10. Approved Software Installation

Use company-managed software distribution whenever possible.

- Install standard applications through the company software catalog.
- Do not download unknown executables or cracked software.
- Request non-standard applications through the Helpdesk.
- Provide a business justification when requested.
- IT may review licensing, privacy, and security requirements.

11. Security Incident Reporting

Scenario	Immediate Action
Phishing email	Do not interact further; report through the security workflow.
Password exposed	Reset the password and contact Security.
Unexpected MFA request	Reject the request and report it.
Lost laptop	Contact IT and Security immediately.
Suspicious software	Follow Security instructions and avoid further interaction.

12. Helpdesk Ticket Quality

A detailed ticket reduces back-and-forth and speeds resolution.

- Use a clear subject.
- State what you expected to happen.
- State what actually happened.
- Include the exact error message.
- List troubleshooting already attempted.
- Include device and application details.
- State the business impact.

- Do not include passwords or MFA codes.

Example Ticket

Subject: VPN connects but Finance Portal is unavailable

Device: Windows laptop, corporate-managed

Expected: Finance Portal loads after VPN connection

Actual: VPN shows Connected, portal times out

Tried: Reconnected VPN and restarted laptop

Impact: Unable to complete today's finance task

13. Frequently Asked Questions

Can IT tell me my password?

No. IT support should never know or request your password.

Can I install any application I want?

No. Use approved software sources and request non-standard applications through IT.

What information should I include in a VPN ticket?

Include the device type, VPN client version if known, time of failure, connection state, and exact error message.

What if my laptop is lost?

Report it immediately to IT and Security. Do not wait until the end of the day.

How long does hardware delivery take?

Timing depends on inventory, approval, shipping, and the type of equipment requested.

14. Escalation Matrix

Issue	Primary Team	Escalate If
Password / MFA	Access Services	Recovery fails or identity issue persists
VPN	Network Operations	Multiple users affected or persistent failure
Laptop	Endpoint Services	Repeated failure or hardware defect
Software	Application Support	Approved troubleshooting fails
Security	Security Operations	Potential credential/data exposure
Hardware Request	Device Services	Non-standard equipment or inventory issue

15. Employee Quick Reference

- I know where to submit an IT ticket.
- I know how to reset my password.
- I know how to connect to the VPN.
- I know how to request hardware.
- I know how to report lost equipment.
- I know how to report suspicious activity.
- I understand that IT will never request my password or MFA code.

16. Final Reminder

When an IT problem occurs, provide clear information, protect your credentials, and report security concerns immediately. Good ticket details help the Helpdesk resolve issues faster.